



Twisha Mehta

Ph.D. Scholar | Public Policy | Governance | Gender Research

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LinkedIn

Indian Institute of Technology Tirupati
Gender • Urban Local Governance • Public Policy • Political Institutions • Quantitative Research

Research Profile

Analytical public policy researcher and Ph.D. scholar at the Indian Institute of Technology Tirupati with an interdisciplinary academic background spanning political science, public policy, gender, urban local governance, and quantitative research. Currently pursuing doctoral research on **Gender and Urban Local Body (ULB) Governance Frameworks**, building on postgraduate training in policy implementation, data analysis, and impact evaluation.

Research interests centre on the relationship between **gender, political representation, governance institutions, and public policy**, with particular interest in how institutional structures shape women’s participation and representation in decision-making. Experienced in computational approaches to political and governance research, policy research, constituency analysis, city-level budget analysis, and evidence-based policy documentation.

Demonstrated research experience through academic conference presentations, published research papers and policy writing, legislative research, political consulting, human-rights research, survey-based research, and interdisciplinary research initiatives.

Current Affiliation

Indian Institute of Technology Tirupati 2026–Present
Ph.D. Scholar

Research Focus: Gender and Urban Local Body (ULB) Governance Frameworks

Doctoral research focused on examining gender and institutional governance frameworks within urban local bodies, with an interdisciplinary orientation towards public policy, political institutions, representation, and governance.

Education

Institution	Degree	Duration	Performance / Focus
Indian Institute of Technology Tirupati	Ph.D.	2026–Present	Gender and ULB Governance Frameworks
Indian Institute of Technology Tirupati	Master of Public Policy	Jul 2024–Present	CGPA: 9.08 ; Policy Implementation, Data Analysis, Impact Evaluation; Dissertation on Women as Policymakers in Vadodara
Kamala Nehru College, University of Delhi	B.A. (Hons.) Political Science	Jul 2021–Jul 2024	CGPA: 7.2 ; Indian Polity, Foreign Policy, Political Theory
Anand Vidya Vihar School	Class XII (CBSE)	2019–2021	97%
Prince Ashokraje Gaekwad School	Class X (CBSE)	2019	86%

Research Experience

Legislative Research Intern & MP CSR Advisory Council Member May–Jun 2025
Office of a Member of Parliament, Lok Sabha

- Conducted legislative and policy research on governance frameworks and constituency development initiatives.
- Contributed to data-driven research and analysis relevant to public policy and constituency-level development.
- Gained exposure to the functioning of legislative institutions, public representatives, constituency priorities, and policy processes.

Political Consultant Intern Apr–Jul 2024
Policy, Politics and Governance Foundation

- Completed the Introductory Course in Political Consulting (ICPC).
- Worked on policy briefs, manifesto development, and constituency-level political analysis.
- Developed practical exposure to political research, electoral analysis, policy communication, and structured briefing.

Public Policy Research Intern Apr–Jun 2023
Policy, Politics and Governance Foundation & NITI Tantra

- Conducted policy research and contributed to three published research papers covering foreign policy, legal issues, and political analysis.
- Developed research and writing skills through structured analysis of contemporary political and policy questions.

Research Mentee Oct 2023–May 2024
Research, Innovation, Sustainable Education Cell (RISE), Kamala Nehru College

- Conducted research on *Cyberstalking in India: A Study of IPC Section 354D*.

- Engaged in structured academic research and developed familiarity with legal, social, and policy dimensions of cyberstalking.

Online Short-Term Intern

Mar 2025

National Human Rights Commission

- Participated in interactive sessions and group projects focused on human-rights issues and institutional understanding.
- Strengthened interdisciplinary understanding of rights-based policy and public institutions.

Research Interests

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| • Gender and Governance | • Gender and Development |
| • Urban Local Governance | • Local Government Institutions |
| • Women in Political Institutions | • Political Economy |
| • Political Representation | • Institutional Analysis |
| • Public Policy | • Quantitative Policy Research |
| • Policy Implementation | • Computational Social Science |

Conference Presentations

- **Behavioural Policy Insights Workshop, Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode** – Presented a research paper at the workshop held on 25–26 June.
- **Southern Regional Conference, Indian Association for the Study of Population (IASP)** – Presented research at the conference jointly organised by the Population Research Centre and Institute for Social and Economic Change (ISEC), Bengaluru, on 24–25 June 2026. Contributed to the sub-theme *Gender, Work and Demographic Change*, examining gendered patterns of representation and governance in South India through computational methods.
- **Research Colloquium, Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT Tirupati** – Presented the paper poster *Gender and Parliamentary Participation: A Computational Analysis of Question Hour in the Lok Sabha (1999–2018)*, March 2026.

Publications & Research Writing

Selected Publications

- *Mahakumbh Mela: A Model for Sustainable Development in Action*. Centre for Development Policy and Practice.
- Co-authored, *An Examination of the Legal and Social Barriers Faced by Women in Accessing Property Rights and Inheritance*. National Human Rights Commission.
- *India's Role in Shaping the G20 Agenda: An Analysis of the Country's Priorities and Contributions*. NITI Tantra.
- *Mob Lynching in India: Assessing the Need for Law Amendment*. NITI Tantra.
- *Analysis of Chhattisgarh Politics*. NITI Tantra.
- *Cyber Stalking in India: Analysing IPC Section 354D*. Research, Innovation, Sustainable Education Cell, Kamala Nehru College.
- Mehta, T., & Pandey, A. K. (2026). *Why Women's Reservation Needs Institutional Design Reform*. Policy Edge.
- Mehta, T., Surya, S. P., & Addepalli, J. (2026, July 22). *Empowered but Unwell – The Health Crisis Hidden in NFHS-6*. Telangana Today.

Research Methods & Technical Skills

Statistical / Analytical Tools	STATA, Python, R
Quantitative Research	Data Analysis, Impact Evaluation, City-Level Budget Analysis, Computational Analysis
Policy Research	Policy Analysis, Governance Research, Constituency Analysis, Policy Implementation Research
Research Methods	Literature Review, Primary Research, Survey Research, Qualitative Research, Evidence Synthesis
Research Communication	Academic Writing, Policy Briefs, Research Papers, Presentations, Documentation
Professional Tools	Microsoft Office Suite, Canva
Professional Skills	Creative Problem Solving, Communication, Teamwork, Project Planning, Task Management, Cultural Sensitivity

Research & Academic Engagement

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| Coordinator, Events Team – NeetiBodh Policy Club, IIT Tirupati | Present |
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- Coordinate academic and policy-oriented events within a student-led public policy platform.
 - Contribute to event planning, coordination, communication, and student engagement.
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| Telephonic Survey Research
<i>Centre for Global Studies, University of Delhi</i> | 2022–2023 |
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- Conducted telephonic survey activities covering the Gujarat Assembly, Delhi MCD, Tripura, Meghalaya, and Karnataka elections.
 - Developed practical exposure to survey-based political research and primary data collection.
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| Annual Academic Publication – Article-Interface | |
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- Published in the annual departmental newsletter of the Department of Political Science, Kamala Nehru College, University of Delhi, in 2022 and 2023.

Awards & Distinctions

- **Best Delegate Award**, Kamala Nehru College Youth Parliament, 2023.
- **Alankar (Masters) in Classical Dance – Bharatnatyam**, 2019.
- **World Record Holder**, Maximum Artists Tribute to Mahatma Gandhi, 2021.

Voluntary & Social Engagement

- **Awareness Programme Lead – Vadodara Wildlife Division:** Led an awareness programme on World Forest Day, 21 March 2021.
- **Rehabilitation Society of the Visually Impaired (RSVI):** Contributed ideas and voice artistry for initiatives supporting visually impaired communities.

Additional Academic Interests

Gender	Urban Governance	Political Institutions
Public Administration	Development Policy	Local Government
Representation	Social Policy	Institutional Reform

References

Academic Reference	Professional Reference
Available upon request	
Available upon request	

Researching institutions. Understanding representation. Advancing evidence-based public policy.